

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 214

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to recognize Jeff Lyash, president and CEO of the Tennessee Valley Authority on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of industry; and

WHEREAS, Jeff Lyash is one such estimable person, who has served with distinction for six years as president and CEO of the Tennessee Valley Authority (TVA), and will soon be taking his much-deserved retirement, capping a more than forty-year career in the energy industry; and

WHEREAS, appointed by the TVA Board of Directors in April 2019, Mr. Lyash led the nation's largest public utility with a focus on building strong partnerships, including the region's 153 local power companies, and managing sustained regional growth and TVA's largest-ever capital investment, which includes new power generation and enhancements to transmission infrastructure; and

WHEREAS, during Mr. Lyash's tenure, TVA has maintained some of the lowest energy costs and highest reliability in the nation; during the COVID-19 pandemic, TVA's financial strength and stability allowed it to provide \$1 billion in customer relief credits in 2020 and a \$200 million rate reduction in 2021; and

WHEREAS, his leadership led TVA to work with regional partners to deliver the next generation of American jobs, helping to create approximately \$45.9 billion in capital investment in the past five years alone, creating or retaining more than 326,000 jobs; and

WHEREAS, TVA's efforts under Mr. Lyash have helped to sustain regional growth at approximately three times the national average; TVA invested over \$22 billion in the past

decade in its power system, including \$4 billion in 2024 alone, and has more than 3,500 megawatts of new generation under construction or online; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lyash played a pivotal role in the development of TVA's Long-term Partnership Proposal, a twenty-year business agreement between TVA and its local power company partners, with ninety-five percent of the region's 153 local power companies signing onto the agreement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lyash oversaw the launch of TVA's \$1.5 billion energy efficiency initiative to assist customers and businesses in reducing their energy costs and using energy wisely; this effort is expected to offset approximately thirty percent of future load growth over the next decade; and

WHEREAS, an advocate and champion for nuclear energy, Jeff Lyash has positioned TVA as a national leader in the development of advanced nuclear technologies; in 2019, TVA became the nation's first utility to successfully obtain approval for an early site permit from the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission to potentially construct and operate a small modular reactor (SMR) at its Clinch River site; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Jeff Lyash has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we extend to Jeff Lyash our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.